Houseplant Care Guide

Watering

Most houseplants die from too much water, not too little. Push a finger two centimetres into the soil: water only when it feels dry at that depth. Succulents and cacti need water every two to three weeks in summer and almost none in winter. Always use pots with a drainage hole.

Light

A monstera or a fiddle leaf fig wants bright indirect light near an east or west window. Snake plants and ZZ plants tolerate low light corners.

Repotting

Repot in spring when roots grow out of the drainage hole. Choose a pot only two to four centimetres wider than the old one and use fresh soil.

Pests

Fungus gnats live in soil that stays wet; let the top layer dry out and use yellow sticky traps. Spider mites show up as fine webbing under the leaves; shower the plant and wipe the leaves weekly until they are gone.